

Session 1 Capstone

In the first session of the podcast, we've been introduced, or likely reintroduced, to a narrative. As you can tell by the length of your Bible and the amount of episodes there are still to be discovered in the podcast, the Story is just getting started.

As we noted in our first companions, there's something eye opening, and hopefully impactful, about looking at this Story that many of us are familiar with, some so familiar that we've fallen victim to the lullaby effect, through multiple lenses. Hopefully, looking at these stories with a different sort of lens has taught you something new, challenged you to wrestle with the Text, or even with God, and also brought you into a community where you can discuss and journey through the wilderness together.

**... the
Story is
just getting
started.**

A major point of reviewing where we've come from in this Story is to be reminded of what the Kingdom of God is like and what He continues to offer us when we lay our heads on the pillow at night and open our eyes to the sun each morning. To show us how He is different—oh-so-much better—than what the world has to offer without Him.

The characters, the outcomes, the mistakes and decisions, aren't always easy to swallow in this Story, so we'd like to remind you of the dichotomy within the Story as we close this study of Torah—for now.

This is a tale of two Kingdoms.

A Kingdom of shalom versus a kingdom of empire. Peace over chaos. Rest over production.

And within this tale we've learned about so many men and women who met this head on—sometimes choosing the Kingdom, sometimes choosing the empire—and this still remains a choice. Just as any beautiful and meaningful relationship should.

**... His Story—a
story that is for
everyone**

Choosing to live in His goodness rather than worry our way into our own solutions. Choosing to put others before ourselves, even if it looks like sacrificing our own comforts, legacy, or deserved inheritance.

We hope that, as you wrestle, move from desert to shade and maybe desert again, you are more encouraged to choose to partner with God in His Story; a Story that is for everyone, the foreigner, the orphan, the widow—and for you.

No matter what you know or what you believe or the many questions you have, we are so grateful you've stuck with us through the first season and first five books of the greatest Story every told. It means more to us than you know. We're a completely donor-supported ministry, and it is because of listeners and supporters and groups like you that we get to keep diving into the Text and sharing it in this way with college students and people around the world.

**We are so
grateful you've
stuck with us.**

May we all take what we've learned throughout our journey from Genesis to Deuteronomy to deepen our roots—to thirst and to dig in even deeper. That we put our hands into the dirt time and again to find a new gem, a new *something* about God that draws us closer into more intimate relationship with Him.

PRAYER

*We bless you, God, for the people who surround us
and for new beginnings.
For the opportunity to learn, to grow, to wrestle,
and to begin again.*

*Help us create space for you in our groups and our lives.
To find safe communities and voices
who speak wisdom and life into us.
To challenge us and remind us
of who You are and where we come from.
May we continue to learn how to trust the Story
as we seek to love You, love others,
and become people of the Text—people of You.*

Amen

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 32

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

What piece of the Text still sits with you strongly from this session? What might you want to go back and dig into more, meditate over, or memorize?



COMMUNITY

Who do you have intentional relationships with that help you practice unity and authenticity? How has this been difficult, eye-opening, etc. during your group's time together?



DISCIPLESHIP

Is there anyone you're taking with you into these new places? Who could you invite into this space or to walk this journey with you?



WRESTLING

What questions do you have after this session? What challenges you about the conversations had and looking through the Text in a different lens? What resonates with you most? What might this mean?



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Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases that we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE *SPIRITUAL FORMATION*

*True success is developing intimacy with God. In this session we encountered the idea of “Creating Space for God” in our lives. We believe that **if we do our part of creating that space, God will fill it** as He desires. You’re already doing this as you dive into the Text and jump into a place to discuss. God will meet you in these places! Continue to look for places the Holy Spirit can do work in and through you as you go about your everyday life.*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS *YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS*

***We believe that young adults are shaping the future of this world.** Jesus modeled a ministry of discipling young adults, and that approach has and will continue to work. If you are a college student who has been listening, we want this material to be directly helpful to your pursuits. If you are not a college student, we want to challenge you to come alongside one and work together.*

SACRED STATION *THEOLOGY OF WORK*

*This isn’t just for our time at church or Bible study; this is about what we do at work every day. How we do our job and how it may take advantage of or bring life to others is something God says is central to our presence in the world. Justice is very much something God cares about. Does our physical work (our 9–5 job) bring shalom or chaos? Does it exploit creation? Which kingdom does it promote? The way we manage our employees, interact with customers or coworkers, care for our children, or create products can provide relief to others. **The work we do every day is sacred and matters!***